

Displaced Aggression Cat Survival Guide — Action Checklist

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SECURE YOUR HOME ENVIRONMENT

- ☐ **Secure your bedroom door tonight with a heavy-duty rubber door sweep to close any gaps underneath, because cats can squeeze through openings as small as three inches and your bedroom is your primary safety zone.:** Secure your bedroom door tonight with a heavy-duty rubber door sweep to close any gaps underneath, because cats can squeeze through openings as small as three inches and your bedroom is your primary safety zone.
- ☐ **Install a secondary barrier at your bedroom entrance such as a baby gate with an opaque cover or a tension rod curtain, because cats with door aggression often scratch and vocalize until you open the barrier, which defeats the purpose of keeping them out.:** Install a secondary barrier at your bedroom entrance such as a baby gate with an opaque cover or a tension rod curtain, because cats with door aggression often scratch and vocalize until you open the barrier, which defeats the purpose of keeping them out.
- ☐ **Identify and prepare one room in your home as your cat-free panic room with a working lock, flashlight, phone charger, and elevated seating, because you need a 30-second escape route when you sense an episode beginning and cannot reach your bedroom in time.:** Identify and prepare one room in your home as your cat-free panic room with a working lock, flashlight, phone charger, and elevated seating, because you need a 30-second escape route when you sense an episode beginning and cannot reach your bedroom in time.
- ☐ **Test all your existing barriers now by assessing whether your cat can open, squeeze under, or reach through any gap, because damaged or loose barriers will fail you exactly when you need them most.:** Test all your existing barriers now by assessing whether your cat can open, squeeze under, or reach through any gap, because damaged or loose barriers will fail you exactly when you need them most.

DEPLOY EMERGENCY TOOLS

- ☐ **Keep self-defense tools within arm's reach at night:** a spray bottle, compressed air canister, or thick blanket, because barriers sometimes fail and you need a way to create distance without causing pain or worsening future episodes.
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- ❑ **Elevate your bed or sleeping area using a platform or tall frame, because cats lose significant ambush advantage when you're above floor level and they cannot easily reach your vulnerable areas while you're sleeping.:** Elevate your bed or sleeping area using a platform or tall frame, because cats lose significant ambush advantage when you're above floor level and they cannot easily reach your vulnerable areas while you're sleeping.
- ❑ **Document every attack with date, time, location, preceding events, and any warning signs you noticed, because identifying patterns helps you predict episodes and gives your veterinary behaviorist crucial information for treatment planning.:** Document every attack with date, time, location, preceding events, and any warning signs you noticed, because identifying patterns helps you predict episodes and gives your veterinary behaviorist crucial information for treatment planning.
- ❑ **Track your cat's response to any supplements, calming products, or medications in a simple log, because what works varies dramatically between individuals and data over weeks reveals patterns that casual observation misses.:** Track your cat's response to any supplements, calming products, or medications in a simple log, because what works varies dramatically between individuals and data over weeks reveals patterns that casual observation misses.

SEEK PROFESSIONAL SUPPORT

- ❑ **Schedule an appointment with a board-certified veterinary behaviorist (not a general vet or trainer) because displaced aggression requires specialized expertise in feline neurology and psychopharmacology that standard practice doesn't cover.:** Schedule an appointment with a board-certified veterinary behaviorist (not a general vet or trainer) because displaced aggression requires specialized expertise in feline neurology and psychopharmacology that standard practice doesn't cover.
- ❑ **Discuss prescription options like SSRIs with your veterinary behaviorist, because these medications can reduce the neurological arousal driving attacks and make behavioral modification efforts actually functional.:** Discuss prescription options like SSRIs with your veterinary behaviorist, because these medications can reduce the neurological arousal driving attacks and make behavioral modification efforts actually functional.
- ❑ **Calculate your physical, emotional, and financial limits honestly, because tracking injuries, medical costs, sleep deprivation, and relationship strain helps you make clear-eyed decisions before you reach crisis.:** Calculate your physical, emotional, and financial limits honestly, because tracking injuries, medical costs, sleep deprivation, and relationship strain helps you make clear-eyed decisions before you reach crisis.

- **Research sanctuary options, no-kill rescues, and specialized rehoming organizations in your area now, before you reach desperation, because informed contingency planning prevents rushed decisions you might regret.:**

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